

Should You Repair Your Home Before Selling in New Braunfels — or Sell As-Is?

A clear-eyed breakdown of when repairs pay off before you list in New Braunfels, when selling as-is nets more, and how to decide with real numbers.

By Todd Spencer · eXp Realty · New Braunfels, TX

At some point, almost every seller stands in front of an aging roof, a foundation crack, or a decade-old HVAC system and asks the same question: fix it now, or let the next buyer deal with it? The honest answer is that it depends — on the specific issue, your timeline, and what New Braunfels buyers are actually willing to pay for versus walk away from. This guide breaks the decision down the way we'd walk through it in person, with real numbers instead of a blanket rule, so you can decide with confidence instead of guessing.

REFRAMING THE QUESTION

The Real Question Isn't "Repair or Not" — It's "Repair for a Buyer, or Price for a Buyer"

Every home eventually sells to somebody. The real decision isn't whether your home's issues get addressed — it's whether you address them before closing, at your pace and on your terms, or whether the next owner does, reflected in a lower price you negotiate today. Both paths can be the right call. The mistake is picking one without actually running the numbers on your specific situation.

What "Selling As-Is" Actually Means in Texas

Selling as-is does not mean a buyer can't inspect the home, and it does not exempt you from Texas's seller disclosure requirements. Under the Texas Property Code, sellers of most residential property must complete a Seller's Disclosure Notice describing known material defects — this obligation exists regardless of whether the listing says "as-is." What as-is actually signals is pricing and negotiating posture: you're telling buyers upfront that you don't plan to make repairs or offer credits after inspection, and the price should already reflect that. Buyers can still inspect, and they can still

walk away during their option period if what they find doesn't match what they expected — as-is limits your obligation to fix things, not a buyer's right to know what they're buying.

The Three Categories of Repairs

Not all deferred maintenance carries the same weight in a buyer's mind or a lender's underwriting. It's useful to sort issues into three buckets before deciding anything: cosmetic (paint, worn flooring, dated fixtures — rarely deal-breakers, cheap to fix, high visual impact), functional or mechanical (aging HVAC, water heater, appliances — moderate cost, often negotiated after inspection either way), and structural or safety (foundation movement, roof leaks, electrical hazards, active water intrusion — expensive, can affect financing, and are the issues most likely to derail a contract if discovered mid-transaction rather than disclosed upfront).

WHEN TO REPAIR

When Repairing First Makes Financial Sense

The clearest case for repairing before listing is when the fix is inexpensive relative to its impact on buyer perception — and when leaving it undone would either scare off a meaningful share of buyers or become a bargaining chip that costs you more in negotiation than the repair itself.

High-ROI Repairs Worth Making

Fresh interior paint in neutral tones is consistently the highest-return pre-listing repair in the New Braunfels market — inexpensive, fast, and it resets a buyer's impression of the entire home's condition. Worn flooring in main living areas, a serviced or repaired (not necessarily replaced) HVAC system, and a properly caulked and cleaned kitchen and bathroom all follow a similar pattern: relatively low cost, disproportionate effect on how buyers perceive overall home condition. A small roof repair — a few missing shingles, a minor flashing issue — is almost always worth fixing before listing, since roof condition is one of the first things a buyer's inspector and lender will flag.

The Math: Repair Cost vs. Price Impact

As a rough framework: if a repair costs a few hundred to a couple thousand dollars and its absence would likely trigger a buyer request for a credit two to three times that amount — which is common, since buyers tend to pad repair credit requests for the hassle of dealing with it themselves — repairing first is almost always the better math. The exception is when you genuinely don't have the cash or the time before your target listing date; in that case, a documented quote from a licensed contractor, disclosed upfront, can sometimes achieve a similar outcome to the repair itself by giving buyers confidence about the actual cost involved rather than letting them assume the worst.

WHEN TO SELL AS-IS

When Selling As-Is Is the Smarter Move

As-is isn't a fallback for sellers who can't be bothered — it's frequently the financially correct choice for a specific set of circumstances, and pretending otherwise costs sellers money and time they didn't need to spend.

Major Structural or Systems Issues

Full foundation repair, a full roof replacement, or a full HVAC system replacement can each run well into five figures — costs that rarely return dollar-for-dollar in New Braunfels' current price bands, particularly in neighborhoods where buyers expect mid-range finishes rather than a fully renovated home. In these cases, an honest, disclosed as-is listing with a price that reflects the needed work typically nets sellers more than spending the cash upfront and hoping the market rewards it fully at resale.

Inherited, Distressed, or Time-Pressured Sales

Sellers handling an inherited property, relocating out of the area on a tight timeline, or managing a sale during a difficult personal circumstance often don't have the bandwidth to manage a repair-and-relist process — and that's a completely legitimate reason to prioritize speed and simplicity over maximizing every dollar. An as-is listing, priced honestly and marketed to the right buyer pool (which can include cash buyers and investors, not just traditional owner-occupants), can close faster and with far less stress than a repair-first approach, even if the top-line number is lower.

HOW BUYERS RESPOND

How New Braunfels Buyers and Inspectors Respond to Deferred Maintenance

Whatever you decide, it helps to understand what actually happens on the other side of the transaction once a buyer is under contract — because “as-is” doesn't remove the buyer's inspection from the process, it just changes what happens after it.

The Option Period Reality

In Texas, buyers negotiate an option period — typically five to ten days — during which they can back out of the contract for any reason and receive their option fee back, inspection findings or not. Even on an as-is listing, buyers will almost always still order an inspection, and if the findings are worse than what was disclosed, or reveal something the buyer genuinely didn't anticipate, some will use the option period to walk rather than negotiate. A thorough, honest disclosure upfront —

sometimes paired with a pre-listing inspection of your own — reduces the odds of a buyer being blindsided mid-contract, which is when deals are most likely to fall apart entirely rather than simply renegotiate.

DECISION FRAMEWORK

A Simple Framework for Deciding

When sellers ask us to just give them a rule of thumb, this is roughly it:

- If the fix costs under \$2,000 and would likely trigger a buyer credit request 2–3x that amount — repair it first.
- If the issue is purely cosmetic (paint, dated fixtures, worn carpet) and you have any time before listing — repair it; the ROI is consistently strong.
- If the fix requires a five-figure investment (full roof, full foundation, full HVAC) — get quotes, then price as-is and disclose fully rather than spending the cash upfront.
- If you're on a tight timeline (relocation, inherited property, personal circumstances) — as-is, priced honestly, is usually the lower-stress and often financially comparable path.
- When in doubt on any specific repair — get a same-day opinion from your agent before committing money or time either way.

PRICING AN AS-IS HOME

Pricing an As-Is Home Correctly

The most common mistake with as-is listings isn't the decision to sell as-is — it's pricing it as though the issues don't exist and hoping buyers won't notice or won't mind. They will notice, and an overpriced as-is home tends to sit far longer than one priced honestly from day one, ultimately forcing a larger price cut than a realistic starting price would have required. The right approach is a comparative market analysis that starts from comparable sold prices for updated homes in your area, then subtracts a realistic, contractor-quoted cost for the known repairs — not a padded discount, and not a token one either. Pricing it this way tends to attract exactly the buyer pool who's already comfortable with the home's condition, which means fewer surprises and fewer renegotiations once you're under contract.

Frequently Asked Questions

Do I have to disclose known issues if I sell my home as-is in Texas?

Yes. Texas law requires most residential sellers to complete a Seller's Disclosure Notice identifying known material defects, regardless of whether the home is marketed as-is. "As-is" changes your obligation to make repairs or offer credits after the buyer's inspection — it does not remove your obligation to disclose what you already know about the property's condition.

Will selling as-is scare away buyers?

It will filter your buyer pool rather than eliminate it. Some buyers, particularly those relying on certain loan programs with strict condition requirements, will pass on an as-is home with significant issues. But a meaningful share of buyers — including cash buyers, investors, and buyers who simply want a lower price in exchange for handling repairs themselves — actively look for as-is listings. The key to attracting the right buyers is honest disclosure and pricing that already reflects the home's condition, rather than trying to disguise it.

What repairs give the best return before selling in New Braunfels?

Fresh neutral-tone interior paint consistently returns the most relative to its cost, followed by refinished or replaced flooring in main living areas, a serviced HVAC system, and thorough deep cleaning with fresh caulking in kitchens and bathrooms. These are inexpensive, fast, and disproportionately shape a buyer's overall impression of the home's condition — far more than their dollar cost would suggest.

Can I sell to a cash buyer or investor if my home needs major work?

Yes, and for homes needing significant structural or systems work, this is often the most efficient path. Cash buyers and investors typically factor repair costs directly into their offer rather than requesting credits after an inspection, which can mean a faster, more predictable closing — though usually at a lower price than a fully repaired home would command from a traditional buyer. Whether this trade-off makes sense depends on your timeline and how much the needed repairs would actually cost to complete.

Should I get a pre-listing inspection?

For homes with any known or suspected issues, yes. A pre-listing inspection lets you see exactly what a buyer's inspector will likely find, on your own timeline rather than mid-contract, which gives you the option to repair known issues, get contractor quotes to support your as-is pricing, or simply disclose everything with confidence. Sellers who skip this step are often surprised — and lose negotiating leverage — when a buyer's inspector finds something unexpected after the home is already under contract.

How do I price a home that needs repairs?

Start with a comparative market analysis based on recently sold, updated homes in your area, then subtract a realistic, contractor-quoted cost for the known repairs — not an arbitrary discount. Pricing too high risks the home sitting on market and eventually requiring a larger correction; pricing with an exaggerated discount leaves money on the table. An agent who builds a repair-adjusted CMA specific to your home and neighborhood will get you closer to the right number than a generic percentage-off rule.

Not sure which path is right for your home? Get a free home valuation grounded in real New Braunfels comps at todd-spencer.com/new-braunfels-home-valuation, or call Todd directly at (512) 665-3747.